

Consent

Purpose:

You are invited to take part in a research study designed to look at how people make social judgments and decisions. You are being asked to participate in this study because we are interested in these processes in a wide variety of people. The purpose of this study is to advance our understanding of how individual differences in cognitive functioning contribute to social behavior.

Procedures:

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to make judgments or decisions about positive and negative outcomes for yourself and for other people, or to write brief descriptions of your own moral experiences. Afterwards, you will be asked questions related to your reactions to the events, as well as some personality traits and background variables that may affect information processing in these tasks. Due to the ongoing coronavirus pandemic, you may also be asked questions related to your experiences about the situation. You may withdraw from this study at any point by closing out of the browser window. Depending on the study, your participation will last between approximately 5 minutes to an hour. You will be paid \$7.25 an hour for your participation in this study.

Risks and Benefits:

There are no known or anticipated risks associated with this study. Depending on the study you are participating in, you may be asked to imagine unpleasant scenarios, but these scenarios are no worse than what you might read about in a news story about a violent event such as a war or a natural disaster. These stimuli may be disturbing to you. Similarly, questions related to coronavirus may be stressful to you, but given that these topics are commonly discussed in everyday discourse (e.g. the news or social media), the information is no worse than what you would normally encounter in daily life. It is recommended that you should not complete this study if you suspect that you will be particularly sensitive to or negatively affected by such scenarios or questions. You will be alerted before you read such scenarios or questions, and you are free to withdraw from the study for any reason at any time.

Although this study will not benefit you personally, we hope that our results will add to the knowledge about how people make decisions about positive and negative outcomes for themselves and for other people.

Confidentiality:

All of your responses will be anonymous. Only the researchers involved in this study and those responsible for research oversight (*such as representatives of the Yale University Human Research Protection Program, and the Yale University Human Subjects Committee*) will have access to any information that you provide. When we publish any results from this study we will do so in a way that does not identify you. We may also share the data with other researchers so that they can check the accuracy of our conclusions but will only do so if we are confident that your confidentiality is protected.

For some studies, we may ask your permission to share some of your data (e.g. descriptions of your own moral experiences) in a non-identifiable way with participants in future studies. You will have the option later in the study to withdraw your permission for us to share your de-identified data with other participants. Withdrawing this permission will not have any penalty.

The researcher will not know your name, and no identifying information will be connected to your survey answers in any way. The survey is therefore anonymous. However, your account is associated with an mTurk or Prolific number that the researcher has to be able to see in order to pay you, and in some cases these numbers are associated with public profiles which could, in theory, be searched. For this reason, though the researcher will not be looking at anyone's public profiles, the fact of your participation in the research (as opposed to your actual survey responses) is technically considered "confidential" rather than truly anonymous. In some studies, you may be asked to optionally provide your Twitter handle. If you choose to provide it, your Twitter screen name will be linked to your survey responses but will be immediately de-identified upon data analysis, so that it will then become anonymous.

Voluntary Participation:

Your participation in this study is voluntary. You are free to decline to participate, to end your participation at any time for any reason, or to refuse to answer any individual question without penalty.

Questions:

If you have any questions about this study, you may contact Dr. Molly Crockett, the person in charge of this research study. She can be reached at molly.crockett@yale.edu.

If you would like to talk with someone other than the researchers to discuss problems or concerns, to discuss situations in the event that a member of the research team is not available, or to discuss your rights as a research participant, you may contact the Yale University Human Subjects Committee, 203-785-4688, human.subjects@yale.edu. Additional information is available at <http://your.yale.edu/research-support/human-research/research-participants>

Are you 18 years of age or older?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Would you like to participate in this study?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Failed Age

Sorry, you can participate only if you are 18 years of age or older, so you will not be able to continue the survey. Please return the assignment.

Thank you for your interest in our research!

Failed Consent

Sorry, you can participate only if you agree to the consent form, so you will not be able to continue the survey. Please return the assignment.

Thank you for your interest in our research!

ProlificID

Welcome!

To begin the study, please enter your Prolific ID into the box below. Prolific IDs have 24 alphanumeric characters.

Attention check 1

In studies like ours, there are sometimes a few people who do not carefully read the questions they are asked and just "quickly click through the survey." These random answers are problematic because they compromise the results of the studies. It is very important that you pay attention and read each question. In order to show that you read our questions carefully (and regardless of your own opinion), please answer "TikTok" in the question on the next page.

When an important event is happening or is about to happen, many people try to get informed about the development of the situation. In such situations, where do you get your information from?

☐ Youtube

- ☐ Twitter
- ☐ TikTok
- ☐ Reddit
- ☐ Newspapers
- ☐ Radio
- ☐ Other
- ☐ TV
- ☐ Facebook

Attention check 2

Please read the following information carefully.

Roses are one of the most popular flowers, grown all around the world. There are now almost three hundred species of roses, with a huge number of different colors, shapes, fragrances, and sizes. While most roses originated in Asia, smaller numbers are native to Europe, North America, and North Africa. Roses are often gardener's favorite plants to grow because of their beauty and the strong fragrance that they have. There are many things to consider when growing roses. While they enjoy sunshine, they are a very thirsty plant and will need regular watering in hotter, drier climates.

On the previous page you read some information about roses. Which of the following was **NOT** discussed?

- ☐ Roses are one of the most popular flowers
- ☐ There are nearly three hundred rose species
- ☐ Most roses originated in Asia
- ☐ Roses can suffer with pests like aphids and blackfly

- ☐ Roses are often thirsty plants and appreciate regular watering
- ☐ Roses often prefer to be planted where they can receive a lot of sunshine

Intro

In this task you will read about a debate that is happening right now around the world.

We will give you some of the justifications that politicians and experts are giving for different policies, and ask you some questions about your opinions.

Please read the scenario carefully and answer as honestly as you can.

Vaccines Intro

COVID-19 remains a public health threat. Pharmaceutical companies have developed effective and safe vaccines, and the U.S. government has purchased hundreds of millions of doses – more than enough to provide first doses and boosters for everyone in the country.

While the U.S. government currently has a large excess of doses, many other countries are dealing with severe shortages of vaccines and do not have enough to even begin giving first doses to their population.

U.S. political leaders are now debating whether these surplus vaccines purchased by the U.S. government should be redistributed around the globe.

Some are arguing that the vaccines should be sent wherever they can achieve the greatest good, even if that means sending them to other countries. Because many people in other countries have still not received any vaccines, they argue that we should redistribute the vaccines to provide first doses to those in other countries.

Others are arguing that the vaccines should be kept in the U.S. to protect American citizens. They argue that because of remaining uncertainties about the pandemic, the government should reserve a supply of extra booster vaccines as a backup in case they are needed, as they might also be effective in the case of an emerging new variant.

Which policy do you think should be adopted?

- ☐ Strongly support surplus U.S.-bought vaccines being reserved for protecting American citizens
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Indifferent
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly support surplus U.S.-bought vaccines being given to whoever needs them most, even if that means sending them to other countries

How morally right or wrong would it be for surplus U.S.-bought vaccines to be given to whoever needs them most, even if that means sending them to other countries?

- ☐ Absolutely morally wrong
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Neither right nor wrong
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Absolutely morally right

Vaccines Trust

Imagine that the mayor of a major city in your region is arguing that surplus U.S.-bought vaccines should be reserved for protecting American citizens.

This mayor said, *"We have a duty to reserve our surplus vaccines as a backup to protect the people in our own country, before we start helping other nations."*

Imagine that the mayor of a major city in your region is arguing that surplus U.S.-bought vaccines should be given to whoever needs them most.

This mayor said, *"We should be impartial in distributing our surplus vaccines and send them where they can achieve the greatest good, even if that means sending them to other countries."*

How trustworthy do you think this person is?

- ☐ Not at all trustworthy
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Somewhat trustworthy
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Extremely trustworthy

How likely would you be to trust this person's advice on other issues?

- ☐ Not at all likely

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Somewhat likely
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Extremely likely

Self-report Comprehension

In the last page, you read about a mayor in a city in your region, and were asked about them. Please select the option that best describes the questions you were asked.

- ☐ How much I trusted the mayor
- ☐ How much I admired the mayor
- ☐ How much I agreed with the mayor

COVID Concerns

How concerned are you now about the health-related consequences of the COVID-19 pandemic?

- ☐ Not at all
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

☐

☐ Very much

How concerned are you now about the financial and economic consequences of the COVID-19 pandemic?

☐

Not at all

☐☐☐☐☐

☐ Very much

Vaccines Attitudes

How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements:

"The COVID-19 vaccines are safe"

☐

Completely disagree

☐☐☐☐☐

☐ Completely agree

"Vaccines are effective at preventing COVID-19"

- ☐ Completely disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Completely agree

"To protect public health, we should follow government guidelines about vaccines"

- ☐ Completely disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Completely agree

Have you received a vaccination for COVID-19?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☐ No

☐ Prefer not to say

Gov Attitudes

How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements:

"The government helped me and my family meet our daily needs during the COVID-19 epidemic in terms of income, food, and shelter."

☐ Completely disagree

☐☐☐☐☐

☐ Completely agree

"I trusted the government's reports on the spread of the epidemic and the statistics on the number of COVID-19 cases and deaths."

☐ Completely disagree

☐☐☐☐☐

☐ Completely agree

"The government had a strong pandemic preparedness team that included public health and medical experts to manage our national response to the COVID-19 epidemic."

- ☐ Completely disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Completely agree

SDR

The following statements may apply more or less to you personally. Please indicate to what extent they apply to you.

"In an argument, I always remain objective and stick to the facts."

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit
- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

"Even if I am feeling stressed, I am always friendly and polite to others."

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit
- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

"When talking to someone, I always listen carefully to what the other person says."

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit
- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

"It has happened that I have taken advantage of someone in the past."

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit
- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

"I have occasionally thrown litter away in the countryside or on to the road."

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit

- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

"Sometimes I only help people if I expect to get something in return. "

- ☐ doesn't apply at all
- ☐ applies a bit
- ☐ applies somewhat
- ☐ applies mostly
- ☐ applies completely

OUS

Please read the following list of statements and indicate how much you agree or disagree with each statement.

"If the only way to save another person's life during an emergency is to sacrifice one's own leg, then one is morally required to make this sacrifice."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"From a moral point of view, we should feel obliged to give one of our kidneys to a person with kidney failure since we don't need two kidneys to survive, but really only one to be healthy."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"From a moral perspective, people should care about the well-being of all human beings on the planet equally; they should not favor the well-being of people who are especially close to them either physically or emotionally."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"It is just as wrong to fail to help someone as it is to actively harm them yourself."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"It is morally wrong to keep money that one doesn't really need if one can donate it to causes that provide effective help to those who will benefit a great deal."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"It is morally right to harm an innocent person if harming them is a necessary means to helping several other innocent people."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree

- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"If the only way to ensure the overall well-being and happiness of the people is through the use of political oppression for a short, limited period, then political oppression should be used."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"It is permissible to torture an innocent person if this would be necessary to provide information to prevent a bomb going off that would kill hundreds of people."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

"Sometimes it is morally necessary for innocent people to die as collateral damage—if more people are saved overall."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

Vaccine Nat Binary

Thinking about developing countries around the world, which statement comes closer to your view about COVID-19 vaccines, even if neither is exactly right?

- ☐ "The U.S. should ensure that there are enough vaccines for people in the U.S., even if it means people in developing countries need to wait longer to get vaccines"
- ☐ "The U.S. should help ensure that people in developing countries have access to vaccines, even if it means some people in the U.S. need to wait longer to get vaccines"

Vaccine Nat Scale

How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements:

"COVID-19 vaccines should be given to all Americans that want one before any are donated to people in other countries."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"Regardless of whether we have enough supply to vaccinate all Americans, vaccine doses should not be shared with other countries."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"The U.S. should cooperate with international efforts aimed at providing vaccines to people that need them in other countries."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐

- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"The U.S. should share the technology required to produce COVID-19 vaccines with other countries, even if it comes at a cost to American companies."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"The U.S. should fund manufacturing facilities in developing countries to expand global vaccine supply."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

Nationalism

"For the most part, the U.S. is better than any other country in the world."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"I would rather be a citizen of the U.S. than of any other country in the world."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

"I am proud to be American."

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐
- ☐ Strongly agree

Demographics

Do you describe yourself as a man, a woman, or in some other way?

- ☐ Man
- ☐ Woman
- ☐ Some other way

How old are you?

Which of the below categories do you identify with?

(Please select all that apply. Note, you may select more than one group).

- ☐ White
- ☐ Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
- ☐ Middle Eastern or North African
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ Some other race, ethnicity or origin

Which country do you currently live in?

- ☐ United States
- ☐ Other

Which U.S. State do you currently live in?

What is the highest level of education you have completed?

- ☐ Some elementary school / primary school
- ☐ Completed elementary school / primary school
- ☐ Some high school / secondary school
- ☐ Completed high school / secondary school
- ☐ Some college / undergraduate degree
- ☐ Completed college / undergraduate degree
- ☐ Some advanced postgraduate degree
- ☐ Completed advanced postgraduate degree

Think of this ladder below as representing where people stand in your country. At the top of the ladder are the people who are the best off, those who have the most money, the most education, and the most respected jobs. At the bottom are the people who are the worst off, those who have the least money, the least education, the least respected jobs, or no job. The higher up you are on this ladder, the closer you are to the people at the very top; the lower you are, the closer you are to the people at the very bottom.

Where would you place yourself on this ladder? Please indicate the number corresponding to the position on the ladder

where you think you stand at this time in your life, compared to people in your country.



In political matters, people talk of "the left" and "the right." How would you place your views on this scale, generally speaking?

- ☐ Left
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Right

How religious are you?

- ☐ Not at all religious
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Somewhat religious
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐ Very religious

Have you heard of this or similar studies before?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Approximately how many COVID-related studies have you participated in before this one?

- ☐ 0
- ☐ 1-5
- ☐ 6-10
- ☐ 11-20
- ☐ 21-50
- ☐ more than 50
- ☐ I don't remember

If you have participated in any other COVID-related studies, how similar were they to this one?

- ☐ Extremely similar
- ☐ Very similar
- ☐ Moderately similar
- ☐ Slightly similar
- ☐ Not at all similar
- ☐ Not applicable

Did any parts of this survey seem unrealistic or confusing to you, and if so, which ones?

In approximately 1 sentence, please tell us what you think this study is about.

THANKS for your participation!

You will be redirected to Prolific on the next page.

This survey is being conducted by researchers at Yale University. If you have any questions about this research or its procedures, risks, or benefits, you may contact Dr. Molly Crockett (molly.crockett@yale.edu). If you are not satisfied with how this study was conducted, or if you have any concerns, complaints, or general questions about your rights as a participant, please contact the Yale University Human Subjects Committee (human.subjects@yale.edu; 203-785-4688). You may also write to the Yale University Human Subjects Committee: P.O. Box 208304, New Haven, CT 06520-8304.

Thank you for participating.

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